Fifth, Carrillo believed that Marx, Engels and Lenin were not infallible, and that their views were open to correction with the passage of time and the evidence of history.

Sixth, Carrillo believed that the Communist party was not infallible either, that at least in non-political matters individuals should feel free to follow their own conscience. In the Spaniard's formulation, 'outside collective political tasks, each [party] member is master of his own fate, as regards everything affecting his preferences, intellectual or artistic inclinations, and his personal relations'. Significantly, he added: 'In the field of research in the sciences of every kind, including the humanities, different schools may co-exist within [the party] and they should all have the possibility of untrammelled confrontation in its cultural bodies and publications.'

Reading Carrillo through the quotes provided by Ranadive, one cannot help but admire his honesty, his overdue but nonetheless brave recognition that the bloody history of his country (and continent) mandated a radical revision of the Communist idea. But B.T. Ranadive saw it very differently. He spoke with contempt of Carrillo's faith in those 'miserable parliamentary elections', and with even more disdain of Carrillo's independence with regard to the Cold War. 'Can any Communist,' he fumed, 'put the enemy of mankind, the gendarme of world reaction, American imperialism, on the same footing as Soviet Russia?'

Carrillo's argument that other political parties should exist, indeed that these parties might even sometimes be correct in their views, was seen by Ranadive as 'giving a permanent charter of existence to non-Marxist, anti-Marxist and unscientific ideologies'. In fact, it amounted to nothing less than a 'liquidation of the Leninist concept of party'. Further, the encouragement of a diversity of thought outside the sphere of politics was 'the final denigration of the Marxist-Leninist Party in the name of freedom for all its members to profess any opinion they like on any subject'. In contrast to the heterodox Spaniard, Ranadive insisted that 'the Party's